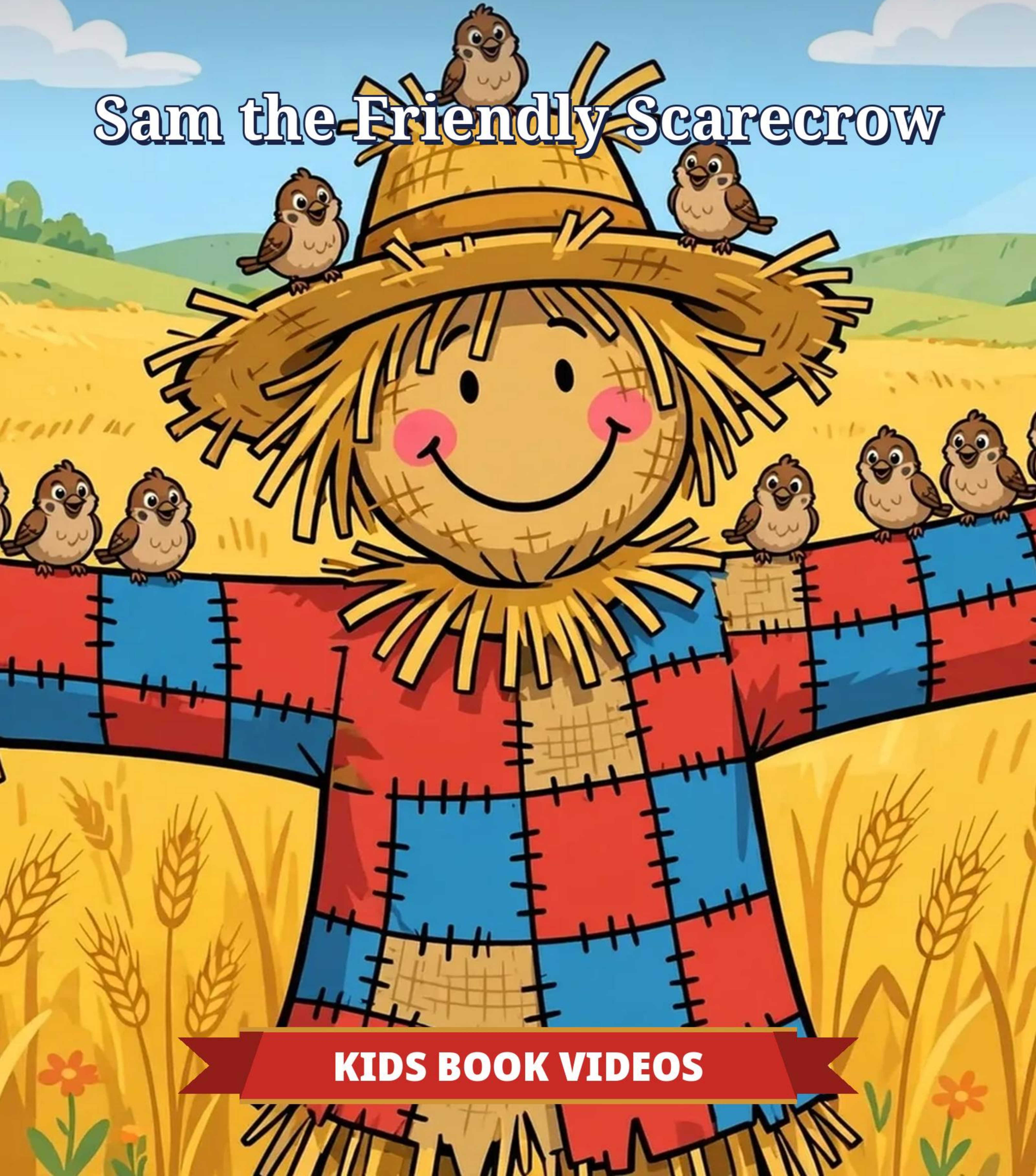


Bedtime Tales

Sam the Friendly Scarecrow



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



In the middle of a wheat field at the edge of Willowmere Wood stood a scarecrow named Sam. He had a straw hat, a patchwork coat, and a painted smile.

But Sam felt lonely. All day he stood with his arms out, and the crows flew far away from him.



"Don't be scared," Sam wanted to say. "I am friendly."

But scarecrows cannot talk. Well, most cannot.



One morning, a little sparrow landed on Sam's hat. She felt tired.

"Hello," chirped the sparrow.



Sam felt surprised — no bird had ever come close before.

The sparrow stayed. She rested on his hat. She felt safe. Sam felt happy, and his straw heart went pitter-pat.



Then more birds came. A robin perched on his arm. A finch sat on his shoulder.

"Stay, stay, stay," seemed to say Sam's smile. That was three times his smile said it.



He felt joyful. Sam was not scaring anyone — he was sheltering everyone.

When rain came, the birds hid under his hat. Pitter-patter went the rain, and the birds stayed dry. Sam felt proud.



When the sun blazed, the birds rested in his shade. Sam felt useful.

The farmer saw all the birds. "My scarecrow is broken," he said. "He does not scare anyone." He felt puzzled.



But then he saw the wheat — growing tall and golden. The birds were eating the bugs, not the wheat!

"Good scarecrow," laughed the farmer. He gave Sam a new hat — a fine red hat. Sam felt fancy.



As evening fell, the birds settled in. The sparrow tucked into Sam's hat. The robin nestled by his shoulder. The finch curled at his elbow.

"Goodnight, birds," whispered the wind for Sam. "Goodnight, goodnight, goodnight." That was three times the wind whispered it.



Sam felt peaceful.

Sleep now, little Sam.

Sleep now, little Sam.

The End

